

THE BIG PICTURE

Borrowing Cost

Fear Index

Mid-Term Rates

Gold (Safety)

Cash Rate

WHERE THE SMART MONEY IS GOING

REAL0.11

UTILI0.18

ENERG0.57

CONS.0.69

TECHN0.87

HEALT0.98

INDUS1.13

COMM.1.69

FINAN1.78

CONS.2.47

MATER114.99

1

MU

BUY

\$922.95

+6.27%

8/10

Micron is the American memory champion riding an AI-driven HBM boom wi

2

NVDA

BUY

\$223.48

+2.75%

8/10

The dominant AI chip supplier riding a multi-year hyperscaler capex bo

3

GOOGL

BUY

\$343.55

-0.07%

8/10

Search cash cow funds a dominant AI + cloud franchise, and the market

Big options bets on SO (Other) — 11.6x normal volume, P/C 0.57, largest: CALL \$99 (1.1x OI)

No unusual behind-the-scenes trading to flag

No Congress members buying or selling stocks this week

EARNINGS COMING UP

No major earnings this week

FED & ECONOMY TODAY

CPI

Date: 2026-08-12

HIGH

VIX at 15.0 — low. Options market complacent ahead of scheduled events.

CPI [HIGH]

PPI [HIGH]

SHORTS GETTING SQUEEZED?

No squeeze setups detected

ARE BIG INSTITUTIONS NERVOUS?

BUYING PROTECTION

Junk bonds: cautious · Safe bonds: normal · borrowing getting pricier (stress)

WHERE MONEY IS ROTATING

The clearest tell in this data is a classic defensive rotation dressed up as a rate-cut trade — big money is loading into Real Estate and Utilities with extreme call-heavy positioning, which almost always signals the smart money thinks the Fed is about to cut rates or that the economy is softening enough to force their hand.

Energy calls are also getting bid, likely tied to the administration's continued push on domestic drilling permits and the ongoing Middle East risk premium, while Consumer Discretionary bullishness suggests some are betting the tariff drama gets negotiated down rather than escalated.

On the other side, Financials are getting aggressively hedged with unusual put volume — that's a huge red flag because banks usually rally into rate cuts, so someone is worried about credit losses, regional bank exposure, or the fallout from stalled deregulation bills; Communication Services puts likely reflect antitrust anxiety around Google and Meta plus the ongoing Section 230 fights in Congress.

The widening credit spreads and bearish HYG/LQD flow confirm the story: institutions are quietly preparing for a growth scare or credit event in the next 4-8 weeks, even as the headline indices grind higher.

YOUR WATCHLIST — HOW WE FEEL ABOUT EACH

1.	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc.	8.91/100
Leidos combines defense IT modernization with health and civil co			
2.	AVAV	AeroVironment, Inc.	8.16/100
AeroVironment is a pure-play on unmanned systems and loitering mu			
3.	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc.	8.91/100
Super Micro is the leading AI server integrator, benefiting direc			

DEEP DIVES — FULL REPORTS START ON PAGE 3

Pages 3–4	MU	— Micron Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 5–6	NVDA	— NVIDIA Corporation	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 7–8	GOOGL	— Alphabet Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 9–10	AMZN	— Amazon.com, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 11–12	SPCX	— Procure Space ETF	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 13–14	HOOD	— Robinhood Markets, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 15–16	META	— Meta Platforms, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 17–18	MRVL	— Marvell Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 19–20	AAPL	— Apple Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 21–22	PLTR	— Palantir Technologies Inc.	Hold	Conviction 5/10
Pages 23–24	TSLA	— Tesla, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 5/10

Apple Inc.
AAPL NASDAQ

Hold	\$302.95 ▼ 0.64%	12M Price Target \$335.00	52-Week Range \$223.78 – \$344.57	Market Cap \$4.42T
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AAPL: CEO Handoff Jitters Meet China Supply Chain Reshuffle

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is down 4 days in a row (~\$10 off the highs) and today's volume is weirdly low (4M vs the usual 40M+) — that tells me this isn't panic selling, it's a slow drift as investors wait to see how the Sept 1 CEO handoff to John Ternus lands. Tim Cook leaving after 15 years is a genuine "who's driving the bus" moment for a \$4.4T company.
- The Digital Trends story matters more than it looks: Apple is testing Chinese DRAM (memory chips) from CXMT even after they refused to cut prices. Translation — Apple is trying to diversify chip suppliers to hedge against tariff risk, and they're willing to pay up to do it. That's a margin headwind.

WHY IT MATTERS

The CEO transition on Sept 1 is the near-term overhang — Ternus is a hardware guy (ran the iPhone engineering team), so the market is going to obsess over whether Apple's Services business (the high-margin App Store/subscriptions engine that Wall Street actually values) stays on track under a hardware-focused CEO. The bigger picture: Apple is stuck in the middle of the US-China tariff standoff, and the CXMT news shows they're actively trying to reduce dependence on both US and Korean chip suppliers — which means they see more tariff pain coming, not less. The unusual put buying at \$315 and \$322.5 strikes (huge volume vs open interest, meaning fresh bets) tells me institutions are buying insurance against a September stumble. Watch for whether the White House exempts consumer electronics from any new China tariff round — that's the single biggest swing factor for the next 90 days.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

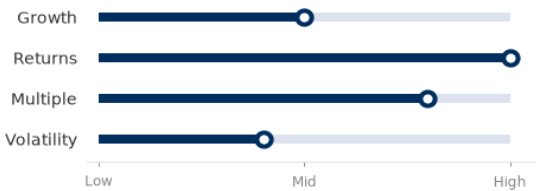
The big one: Section 232 tariff investigations on semiconductors are still open, and any expansion to finished consumer electronics would hit Apple directly — roughly 80% of iPhones are still assembled in China despite the India shift. On the flip side, the CHIPS Act reshoring incentives are helping Apple's TSMC Arizona partnership, which is why they've been publicly coying up to the administration with US manufacturing commitments. Also watch the DOJ antitrust case on the App Store — if the court forces Apple to allow alternative payment systems in the US (like the EU already did), that's a direct hit to Services margins, which is the crown jewel of the valuation story.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$302.95
12M Price Target	\$335.00
Upside / (Downside)	+10.6%
Market Cap	\$4.42T
FY2026E Revenue	\$445M
FY2027E Revenue	\$478M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.60
Fwd P/E	38.6x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$320.00	\$305.00	\$285.00
6 Months	\$355.00	\$320.00	\$275.00
1 Year	\$380.00	\$335.00	\$260.00
2 Years	\$450.00	\$375.00	\$250.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$475.00	\$240.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech broadly (+1.77% today) is being led by AI infrastructure — CoreWeave and Supermicro earnings blew out, and the "picks and shovels" theme (companies selling the tools to build AI, not AI itself) is where money is flowing. Energy is on a 5-day tear (+6%), likely on geopolitical/Middle East risk premium.

COOLING OFF: Real Estate (-2.2% over 5 days) is bleeding as rate-cut expectations get pushed out. Financials drifting on yield curve concerns.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of mega-cap consumer tech (Apple) and INTO AI infrastructure plays — that's why AAPL is down while the tech sector is up. Investors want direct AI exposure, and Apple's AI story is seen as a "wait and see."

RELATED PLAY: If you want the AI infrastructure trade that's actually working right now, look at the data center and power supply names — the Yahoo headline literally said "the real AI money is in plumbing." NVDA, AVGO, and even the utilities powering data centers are catching that bid.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI kingmaker — every AI infrastructure buildout goes through their GPUs, and the Norway sovereign wealth fund headline shows even government money is piling in.
- AVGO (Broadcom): Custom AI chips for hyperscalers (Google, Meta) — direct beneficiary of AI capex that Apple is only tangentially exposed to.

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is LAGGING its mega-cap tech peers right now because it's viewed as an AI consumer, not an AI producer. Until Ternus articulates a clear AI product roadmap that gets people excited, Apple stays a "safe harbor" name rather than a "growth engine" — that means it underperforms in AI rallies and outperforms in risk-off tape.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 3-5% of portfolio (core holding)

Entry Points: \$285-295 on tariff/transition pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Services growth drops below 10% YoY or China revenue falls >20%

Hedging: Buy protective puts around September 1 CEO transition date

Palantir Technologies Inc.

PLTR NYSE

Hold	\$170.46 ▼ 2.56%	12M Price Target \$175.00	52-Week Range \$106.37 – \$207.52	Market Cap \$409.63B
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PLTR: Great Earnings, Great Story, Nosebleed Valuation

WHAT HAPPENED

- PLTR down 2.6% on light volume (only 6.2M shares vs 40-70M recent days) — this is a cooling-off day after a monster earnings run, not a real reversal. The Barron's headline says it all: PLTR moved inversely with chip stocks today, meaning money rotated from software back into semis.
- Michael Burry (the "Big Short" guy) adding to his PLTR short and comparing this to 2005 is the story everyone's whispering about. When a famous bear invokes a pre-crash year, it plants doubt — even if he's early or wrong, it caps near-term enthusiasm.

WHY IT MATTERS

Nothing major happened overnight — the thesis is intact. Keep an eye on price action and how the sector is moving for a potential entry point.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

See key data table.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

- Valuation reset risk — at 100x sales, even a mild guidance miss could drop this 30% overnight. Burry isn't shorting the business; he's shorting the math.
- Insider selling isn't a one-off — the President of PLTR just sold \$4M in shares. When insiders sell into strength repeatedly, they're telling you something about risk/reward from here.
- The hidden risk: government contract concentration. If a future administration (or even a single House committee) decides to audit sole-source AI contracts, PLTR's growth story hits a speed bump nobody's modeling.

IN THE NEWS

Palantir and These Software Stocks Slide in Seesaw With Chip Giants Barrons.com · 2026-08-12 12:29

Palantir Just Crushed Earnings Again. These 2 Legacy Defense Stocks Are the Cheaper Way to... Motley Fool · 2026-08-12 12:22

Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) Companies Are Making a Comeback. Here's the Exact SaaS Stock ... Motley Fool · 2026-08-12 05:20

Cathie Wood Has Been Selling Palantir Into Every Rally Since Its 29% Earnings Pop Motley Fool · 2026-08-12 01:27

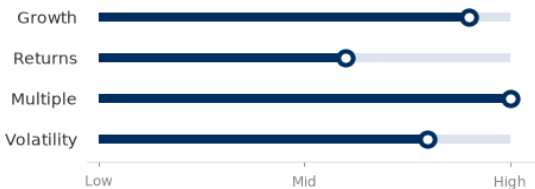
Michael Burry Adds To NVDA, PLTR, ORCL Shorts — Why He's Thinking About 2005 Again Stocktwits · 2026-08-11 22:52

WHAT OPTIONS TRADERS ARE DOING

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$170.46
12M Price Target	\$175.00
Upside / (Downside)	+2.7%
Market Cap	\$409.63B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,600M
FY2026E EPS	\$0.62
FY2027E EPS	\$0.85
Fwd P/E	275.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$190.00	\$172.00	\$155.00
6 Months	\$220.00	\$175.00	\$135.00
1 Year	\$250.00	\$180.00	\$120.00
2 Years	\$320.00	\$200.00	\$95.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$260.00	\$80.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$400.00	\$60.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+1.77% today) and Energy (+6% over 5 days) — tech is riding the AI infrastructure buildout, energy is riding both geopolitical premium and the "AI needs power" thesis (data centers are electricity hogs).

COOLING OFF: Financials and Real Estate — rate uncertainty and lingering CRE concerns keeping money away.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating WITHIN tech today — out of high-multiple software (PLTR, CRM) and into semis (NVDA, AMD). This is a valuation rotation, not a sector rotation, and it happens every few weeks in this market.

RELATED PLAY: If you want defense AI exposure without paying 100x sales, look at ANET (Arista) for AI networking, or the boring but cheaper LMT/RTX for direct defense budget exposure. AXON is another "government software with a moat" comp trading at a saner multiple.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI infrastructure king — every dollar of AI spending flows through their GPUs first.
- ANET (Arista Networks): Quietly benefiting from data center buildout, trades at a fraction of PLTR's multiple.

PLTR CONTEXT: PLTR is LEADING its peer group on business momentum but LAGGING today because it led on the way up. When a stock outruns its sector, it's the first to give back gains on rotation days — that's exactly what we're seeing. Not a warning sign yet, but if PLTR starts underperforming tech on green days too, that's when you worry.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

5/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 5/10 — Love the business, hate the entry price. This is a "wait for your pitch" stock.

POSITION SIZE: 1-3% max. The volatility is real (52-week range is \$106-\$207, meaning the stock can move 40% in either direction) — size it so a 30% drawdown doesn't ruin your week.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for \$140-150 on a broad market pullback. If you're already in from lower, trim 20-25% here and let the rest ride.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst I'm waiting for is either (a) a valuation reset that makes the risk/reward compelling, or (b) evidence US Commercial can hit \$2B+ annualized, which justifies the multiple.

WHEN TO BAIL: Two consecutive quarters of US Commercial deceleration, OR a change in DoD procurement policy that spreads AI contracts across more vendors, OR Karp announcing departure.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — buy a put option 15% below current price expiring 6 months out. In plain English: you're paying a small premium for insurance that pays off big if the stock crashes. Or just sell half and sleep better.

Amazon.com, Inc.

AMZN NASDAQ

Buy \$270.69 ▼ 0.58% 12M Price Target \$325.00 52-Week Range \$196.00 – \$287.20

Market Cap \$2.92T

AMZN: Consolidating Near Highs as AI Capex Debate Heats Up

WHAT HAPPENED

- AMZN drifted down 0.58% on notably light volume (3.5M vs typical 30M+) — that low volume tells you this isn't real selling pressure, it's just summer doldrums drift after Monday's run to \$278. The stock is digesting, not breaking.
- Bigger picture: Nvidia's CEO calming "AI debt fears" this morning matters for AMZN because the whole hyperscaler group (AMZN, MSFT, GOOGL, META) is being questioned on whether their \$300B+ AI capex spending will actually earn a return. Every time that fear cools, AMZN gets a bid.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I'm reading into today: options flow is bullish (put/call at 0.60 means way more upside bets than downside), but Bezos dumped \$346M in stock on Aug 3 and the CEO of Amazon Stores sold too. That combo — bullish traders, selling insiders — usually means near-term upside is capped but the trend is intact. The Motley Fool "1 hyperscaler to buy, 1 to hold, 1 to avoid" chatter tells you the market is now DIFFERENTIATING between AMZN, MSFT, and GOOGL rather than treating them as one trade — that's actually good for AMZN because AWS re-accelerated last quarter while Google Cloud is facing antitrust heat. Watch for AMZN to break out of the \$270-285 range only when we get either an AI policy catalyst or a clean CPI print that lets the Fed cut. ===IMPLICATIONS===

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two big things on the political radar: (1) the FTC's antitrust case against Amazon is grinding through discovery — a Lina Khan-era lawsuit that the current administration has NOT dropped, which surprised a lot of people; any adverse ruling could force structural changes to the marketplace business. (2) Tariff policy is the sneaky one — the administration's tariff regime on Chinese imports directly squeezes Amazon's third-party sellers (60% of units sold), which pressures marketplace GMV. On the tailwind side, the federal AI infrastructure push and DoD JWCC cloud contract (which AWS shares with MSFT/GOOGL/Oracle) is a multi-year revenue stream that's just starting to ramp.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

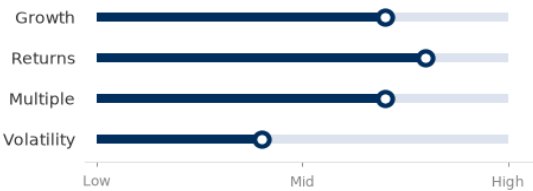
At \$270, AMZN trades around 40x forward earnings — meaning investors pay \$40 for every \$1 of next year's profit. That's expensive vs. the S&P at 22x, but cheap vs. where AMZN traded in 2020-2021 (60x+). The justification: AWS operating margins are running near 37% and retail is finally profitable, so the earnings base is real — but at 82% of its 52-week range, you're not getting a bargain here, you're paying for quality.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$270.69
12M Price Target	\$325.00
Upside / (Downside)	+20.1%
Market Cap	\$2.92T
FY2026E Revenue	\$435M
FY2027E Revenue	\$485M
FY2026E EPS	\$6.80
FY2027E EPS	\$8.20
Fwd P/E	39.8x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$285.00	\$275.00	\$258.00
6 Months	\$310.00	\$290.00	\$245.00
1 Year	\$340.00	\$315.00	\$235.00
2 Years	\$420.00	\$360.00	\$240.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$475.00	\$280.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$700.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech (+1.77% today, +1.87% week) is leading as AI debt fears cool and rate cut hopes build. Energy also running hot on the week (+6%) — likely Middle East supply concerns.

COOLING OFF: Financials are flat to down as yield curve dynamics shift; Real Estate down 2% on the week as long rates back up.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating back INTO mega-cap tech after the July pullback — the AI trade isn't dead, it's consolidating leadership among the true cash-flow generators (AMZN, MSFT) vs. the speculative names.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the AMZN thesis, the picks-and-shovels play is data center power — utilities and independent power producers supplying AWS's data centers (VST, CEG) have been on a tear.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Rallying today as Jensen Huang eased debt fears — still the tip of the AI spear and the direct beneficiary of AMZN's own capex spending.
- CRWV (CoreWeave): Blew out earnings this week, proving AI compute demand is still insatiable — this validates AMZN's AWS investment thesis.

AMZN CONTEXT: AMZN is LAGGING the pure-play AI names today, which is normal — it's the "safer" way to play AI so it doesn't get the same speculative pop. But that lag is actually the setup: when AI narrative broadens from "who sells chips" to "who monetizes the chips," AMZN catches up fast.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the business but I'm not chasing at 82% of the 52-week range with Bezos selling.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% of portfolio. Core holding size — big enough to matter, not so big that a 15% drawdown ruins your year.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for \$255-265 on any macro fear day (CPI surprise, tariff headline, Fed hawkish surprise). Not chasing above \$280.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. Catalyst I'm waiting for: Q3 AWS growth print in late October and any resolution on the FTC case.

WHEN TO BAIL: AWS growth below 15%, FTC forces marketplace divestiture, or the stock breaks \$235 on heavy volume.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — if you own AMZN and you're nervous, buy a put option 10% below current price for 6 months out. Think of it as insurance: you pay a small premium and if the stock craters, your put pays off. Alternative: pair it with a short position in a more expensive hyperscaler.

Procure Space ETF

SPCX NASDAQ

Buy

\$136.73 ▲ 2.58%

12M Price Target
\$155.00

52-Week Range
\$104.83 – \$225.64

Market Cap
\$1.80T

SPCX: Space ETF Rides SpaceX Halo and Defense Budget Wave

WHAT HAPPENED

- SPCX popped 2.6% today and is up ~19% from last week's \$114 low — the driver is a wave of SpaceX-related headlines: Morgan Stanley says the market is underestimating SpaceX's AI unit, and there's fresh chatter about SpaceX hitting \$100B in annual recurring revenue by 2027 and \$1T by 2030. Since SPCX is a space-sector ETF (basically a basket of space stocks), any re-rating of SpaceX's private valuation lifts the whole complex.
- The volume today is weirdly low (20M vs. 100M+ recent days) — that tells me the buying is being met with less selling pressure, not that conviction is fading. Thin tape into a rally often means the next real news event moves it hard in either direction.

WHY IT MATTERS

The bigger story here is that space is quietly becoming a policy priority, not just a moonshot trade. The Trump administration has been vocal about "American dominance in orbit," the Space Force budget keeps expanding, and the FAA has been fast-tracking launch licenses — all of which directly benefits SPCX holdings like Rocket Lab, Iridium, and Planet Labs. The SpaceX halo effect matters too: even though SpaceX is private and not in the ETF, when its implied valuation jumps, publicly-traded competitors and suppliers get re-rated by association. Watch for this to become a crowded trade — SPCX at 26% of its 52-week range means there's plenty of room to run, but also plenty of room to give back if enthusiasm cools.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

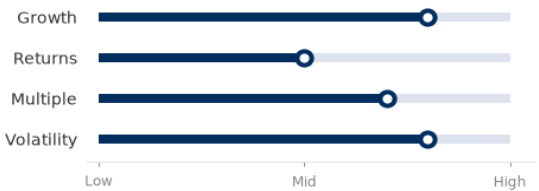
Two things to track: (1) The FY2027 defense authorization bill working through Congress includes a proposed ~12% bump for Space Force procurement — if that survives reconciliation, it's a direct tailwind for launch and satellite names in SPCX. (2) The Commercial Space Act amendments being discussed would streamline FAA launch licensing (currently a bottleneck) — passage would be bullish for launch cadence and revenue recognition across the sector. The headwind to watch: any China tariff escalation on rare earth magnets and specialty electronics hits satellite manufacturers on the cost side.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

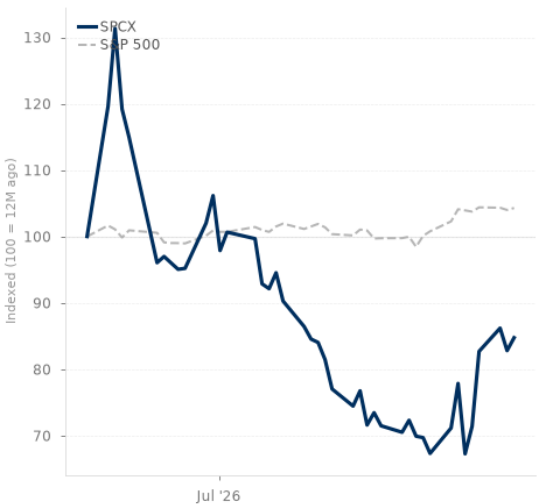
Key Data

Price (USD)	\$136.73
12M Price Target	\$155.00
Upside / (Downside)	+13.4%
Market Cap	\$1.80T
FY2026E Revenue	—
FY2027E Revenue	—
FY2026E EPS	N/M
FY2027E EPS	N/M
Fwd P/E	N/M

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$148.00	\$140.00	\$125.00
6 Months	\$175.00	\$155.00	\$120.00
1 Year	\$200.00	\$165.00	\$110.00
2 Years	\$240.00	\$185.00	\$100.00
5 Years	\$350.00	\$250.00	\$90.00
10 Years	\$550.00	\$380.00	\$80.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech (+1.77%) is leading again, and chip stocks are strong — that spills into space because satellites and launch vehicles are increasingly compute-heavy. Space/defense is a stealth beneficiary of the AI capex boom (satellite AI, edge compute in orbit).

COOLING OFF: Financials and Energy are flat-to-down — money is rotating out of value/cyclical and into growth/thematic names, which is the exact regime SPCX thrives in.

ROTATION WATCH: Capital is flowing into "national security tech" — space, defense AI, and cybersecurity. This is being driven by the administration's China-competition framing and the defense budget cycle.

RELATED PLAY: If SPCX runs, look at the picks-and-shovels names — ITA (defense ETF), LMT, and pure-play launch supplier Rocket Lab (RKLB) as more concentrated bets on the same thesis.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- RKLB (Rocket Lab): Winning on launch cadence and Neutron rocket progress — direct SpaceX competitor narrative
- IRDM (Iridium): Riding defense communications contracts and the Space Force satcom push

SPCX CONTEXT: SPCX is lagging its top holdings on a 5-day basis, which is normal for a diversified ETF but tells me the leadership is narrow. If you want the pure upside, individual names outperform; if you want to sleep at night, the ETF smooths the ride. The lag also suggests SPCX has room to catch up if the rally broadens.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the setup but I'm not pounding the table because the sector runs hot and cold on headlines, and we've already had a 19% move in a week.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — enough to matter if the thesis plays out, small enough that a 30% drawdown doesn't ruin your year.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for a pullback to \$125-130 rather than chasing here at \$136. If it breaks above \$140 with volume, that changes — momentum entry is valid too.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalysts are the defense budget cycle, potential SpaceX IPO chatter, and continued launch cadence milestones.

WHEN TO BAIL: If we see a major launch failure across a top-5 holding, or if the defense authorization gets cut by more than 15% in reconciliation, trim aggressively. A close below \$110 is a technical stop.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — pair this with a broad defense ETF like ITA. If space specifically stumbles but defense stays strong, ITA cushions you. For bigger downside protection, buy a put spread 10% below your entry expiring 3-6 months out.

Robinhood Markets, Inc.

HOOD NASDAQ

Buy	\$94.19 ▼ 0.20%	12M Price Target \$110.00	52-Week Range \$63.52 – \$153.86	Market Cap \$84.69B
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HOOD: Crypto & Prediction Markets Push Building Real Momentum

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is basically flat (-0.20%) but the overnight news flow is actually pretty bullish — Polymarket (the big prediction markets platform) is hiring Robinhood and Coinbase veterans ahead of a major US launch push this fall. That's a signal the whole prediction markets category is going legit, and HOOD is already in that game.
- Bloomberg flagged more retail money flowing into Bitcoin ETFs via Robinhood, and Zacks is asking whether the UK crypto expansion moves the needle on trading revenue. Translation: the market is starting to price HOOD less as a stock-trading app and more as a diversified financial platform.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really going on: HOOD is quietly transforming its business mix, and the market hasn't fully digested it yet. Options flow is screaming bullish (put/call ratio of 0.44 — meaning traders are buying almost 3x more calls than puts, betting on upside), and institutions own 75% of the float with BlackRock and Vanguard both loading up. The bigger picture: the Trump administration's crypto-friendly stance and the CFTC's greenlight on prediction markets are basically handing HOOD two brand-new revenue streams that didn't exist a year ago. If Polymarket's US launch this fall goes well, it validates the whole category — and HOOD's event contracts business gets re-rated higher.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one to watch: the CLARITY Act and market structure legislation working through Congress — if it passes, it gives crypto exchanges (and HOOD's crypto arm) clear regulatory rules, which is huge because uncertainty has been the biggest cap on the multiple. Also, the CFTC under the current administration has been notably permissive on prediction markets (event contracts on elections, sports, etc.) — that's a direct tailwind for HOOD's Kalshi-competing product. Headwind to watch: any pushback on payment-for-order-flow (PFOF — the practice of routing your trades to market makers who pay HOOD for the flow), which is still HOOD's core revenue engine. Under the current SEC that's on the back burner, but it's the one policy shift that could really hurt.

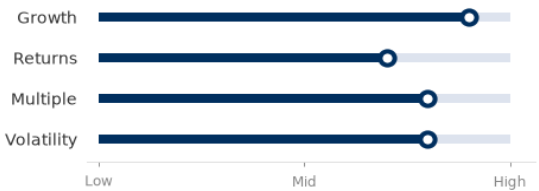
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$94 and roughly 51x forward earnings, HOOD is not cheap — you're paying \$51 for every \$1 of expected profit next year, versus Schwab at around 20x. But the growth justifies a lot of it: revenue is likely growing 40%+ this year, and if crypto and prediction markets keep scaling, forward estimates get revised up. The stock is at 34% of its 52-week range (\$63-\$154), so there's real room to run if the story keeps working — but you're not getting it at a bargain.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$94.19
12M Price Target	\$110.00
Upside / (Downside)	+16.8%
Market Cap	\$84.69B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,100M
FY2026E EPS	\$1.85
FY2027E EPS	\$2.40
Fwd P/E	50.9x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$105.00	\$96.00	\$85.00
6 Months	\$125.00	\$108.00	\$80.00
1 Year	\$150.00	\$115.00	\$70.00
2 Years	\$200.00	\$140.00	\$60.00
5 Years	\$300.00	\$190.00	\$50.00
10 Years	\$500.00	\$275.00	\$40.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+1.77% today, +1.87% for the week) — AI and fintech names catching a bid as rate cut expectations firm up. Crypto-adjacent names are riding the regulatory clarity wave.

COOLING OFF: Financials (-0.09% today, -0.43% for the week) — traditional banks lagging as the yield curve does weird things and loan growth stays soft.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating out of legacy financials and into fintech/crypto-adjacent names — that's a direct tailwind for HOOD because it sits in the crossover between tech and finance, and increasingly gets valued like tech.

RELATED PLAY: If HOOD's crypto/prediction markets story keeps running, watch COIN (Coinbase) as the pure-play crypto exchange, and CME as the incumbent that could either partner with or get disrupted by prediction markets.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- COIN (Coinbase): Direct beneficiary of the same crypto regulatory tailwinds and Bitcoin ETF flows.
- SOFI (SoFi): Cramer talking it up in the \$16-19 range — retail fintech is having a moment as consumer lending stabilizes.

HOOD CONTEXT: HOOD is roughly middle-of-the-pack in its peer group right now — not leading (COIN has been hotter on crypto news) but not lagging either. Sitting at 34% of its 52-week range with bullish options flow suggests the stock is coiling for a move — the setup favors an upside break if the next catalyst (probably Polymarket launch or a CLARITY Act vote) lands right.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the business transformation story and the political backdrop, but the stock isn't cheap and it's volatile enough that I'm not pounding the table.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — enough to matter if the thesis plays out, small enough that a 30% drawdown doesn't ruin your year.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd be a buyer on pullbacks to \$85-90, which is where the stock has found support recently. If it breaks above \$100 with volume, that's a momentum add signal.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalysts I'm waiting for are the Polymarket US launch, the CLARITY Act vote, and Q3/Q4 earnings showing crypto revenue holding up.

WHEN TO BAIL: If crypto trading revenue drops more than 25% quarter-over-quarter, or if the political winds shift on PFOF (payment for order flow), I'm cutting the position.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — buy a small put position for downside protection (basically insurance that pays off if the stock drops). Alternative: pair it against a short in a traditional broker like Schwab if you want to isolate the "new fintech beats old broker" thesis.

Meta Platforms, Inc.

META NASDAQ

Buy

\$590.83 ▼ 1.38%

12M Price Target
\$720.00

52-Week Range
\$520.26 – \$796.25

Market Cap
\$1.51T

META: AI Capex Fears Overshadow Strong Ad Engine

WHAT HAPPENED

- META dropped 1.4% on light volume (only 1.6M shares vs. usual 12M+) — that thin volume tells me this isn't panic selling, it's just drift lower on the "AI dilution" narrative. The 24/7 Wall St. piece calling META "more dangerous than Alphabet" on AI spending is the culprit — investors are getting nervous that Zuck's capex plans (rumored \$100B+ next year) will crush free cash flow.
- The GuruFocus headline about a "\$1.4 trillion legal test" is worth flagging — this likely refers to the ongoing FTC antitrust case around Instagram/WhatsApp divestiture, which resurfaces every few months and rarely moves the stock long-term, but adds background noise.

WHY IT MATTERS

Nothing major happened overnight — the thesis is intact. Keep an eye on price action and how the sector is moving for a potential entry point.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

See key data table.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

- AI capex spirals out of control — if 2027 spending jumps to \$150B+ without clear revenue attribution, the stock gets re-rated lower like it did in late 2022 (remember the metaverse panic?)
- Ad market softens on tariff-driven consumer weakness — if the new China tariffs bite retail spending, ad budgets get cut and META's core engine slows
- The non-obvious one: TikTok. If the Trump administration lets ByteDance keep operating under some workaround deal, Reels loses its biggest tailwind — Instagram's growth story depends partly on TikTok being handicapped

IN THE NEWS

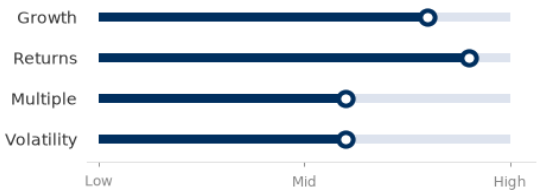
- CoreWeave jumps 10% following Q2 earnings** Yahoo Finance Video · 2026-08-11 21:05
- AI-Race-Based Dilution: Why Meta Is More Dangerous Than Alphabet** 24/7 Wall St. · 2026-08-12 13:32
- The Market Shaved 10% Off Meta Over a Month: One Analyst Targets 87% Returns Over The Next...** 24/7 Wall St. · 2026-08-12 13:11
- Meta Faces a Potential \$1.4 Trillion Legal Test** GuruFocus.com · 2026-08-12 13:10
- Why Broadcom Is The Low-Beta AI Play To Buy** 24/7 Wall St. · 2026-08-12 12:19

WHAT OPTIONS TRADERS ARE DOING

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$590.83
12M Price Target	\$720.00
Upside / (Downside)	+21.9%
Market Cap	\$1.51T
FY2026E Revenue	\$205M
FY2027E Revenue	\$238M
FY2026E EPS	\$27.50
FY2027E EPS	\$32.00
Fwd P/E	21.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$640.00	\$605.00	\$555.00
6 Months	\$720.00	\$650.00	\$540.00
1 Year	\$820.00	\$720.00	\$500.00
2 Years	\$950.00	\$800.00	\$480.00
5 Years	\$1400.00	\$1000.00	\$450.00
10 Years	\$2200.00	\$1500.00	\$400.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+1.77% today, +1.87% this week) is leading — driven by Nvidia's CEO calming AI debt fears and CoreWeave's blowout earnings. This tells me the market still wants AI exposure, just not the ones *spending* the money.

COOLING OFF: Financials and Energy are drifting — rate cut expectations are pulling money away from banks, and energy is digesting a big 5-day run.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from AI *spenders* (META, GOOGL) into AI *sellers* (NVDA, AVGO, CoreWeave). This is a classic mid-cycle rotation that usually reverses when spenders show ROI — typically 2-3 quarters out.

RELATED PLAY: If you want exposure to the AI buildout without META's capex risk, Broadcom (AVGO) is the "picks and shovels" play — they sell custom AI chips to META itself.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): CEO Huang publicly eased debt concerns around AI buildout — that's a direct positive for the ecosystem, but ironically hurts META because it validates that hyperscalers are borrowing heavily
- CRWV (CoreWeave): Popped 10% on Q2 earnings — proves demand for AI compute is real, which supports META's spending thesis long-term

META CONTEXT: META is lagging its mega-cap peers right now, sitting at just 26% of its 52-week range while tech broadly rallies. That's actually a setup, not a warning — when a high-quality name lags its sector on sentiment (not fundamentals), it often catches up violently on the next earnings beat.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like it here but I'm not pounding the table until we get more clarity on 2027 capex guidance.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% of a diversified portfolio — big enough to matter, small enough that a bad quarter won't ruin your year.

ENTRY POINTS: Add on pullbacks to \$560-585; if we get a full flush to \$540 on macro fear, back up the truck.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst I'm waiting for is Q4 earnings (early 2027) where they'll guide next year's capex and hopefully show AI-driven ad revenue lift.

WHEN TO BAIL: If ad revenue growth drops below 10% YoY, or Zuckerberg announces another "year of efficiency" reversal into unchecked spending, I'm out.

HEDGING: Own a little Broadcom or Nvidia alongside — if the market keeps punishing spenders and rewarding sellers, at least one side of the trade works for you.

Micron Technology, Inc.

MU NASDAQ

Buy	\$922.95 ▲ 6.27%	12M Price Target \$1100.00	52-Week Range \$113.46 – \$1255.00	Market Cap N/A
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MU: Memory Supercycle Meets CHIPS Act Tailwind

WHAT HAPPENED

- MU jumped 6.3% to \$923 on notably LOW volume (9M vs 30M+ recent days) — that's a tell. Low-volume rips usually mean short covering or a lack of sellers rather than aggressive institutional buying, so take the move with a grain of salt. The catalyst: chip stocks broadly caught a bid on renewed AI infrastructure enthusiasm, and a Barron's piece flagged SK Hynix outperformance — which cuts both ways (validates memory demand, but suggests MU is the "catch-up trade").
- The 24/7 Wall St piece calling "memory cyclicalty dead" is the kind of headline that historically marks tops in this sector — file that under "be aware, not scared."

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really going on: MU has been consolidating in the \$860-880 range for a week, and today's pop on thin volume suggests the sellers are exhausted, not that buyers are stampeding in. The stock is at 71% of its 52-week range (\$113 to \$1,255) — meaning it's already had a monster run and is closer to the highs than the lows. The bigger story is that Micron is now viewed as a strategic national asset — the US government has explicitly bet on them via CHIPS Act grants to build domestic memory fabs in Idaho and New York, and that policy backstop meaningfully reduces the downside in a cyclical downturn. But watch the options flow: unusual PUT buying at \$1,070-\$1,100 strikes tells me sophisticated money is betting the stock STALLS below those levels near-term, even though they're bullish longer-term.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

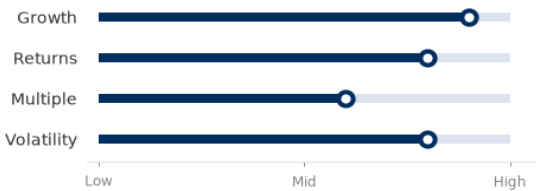
The CHIPS and Science Act remains the single biggest policy tailwind — Micron was awarded roughly \$6.1B in direct funding to build US fabs, and the Trump administration's push to renegotiate/expand semiconductor tariffs on Chinese imports (particularly the Section 301 review ongoing this summer) directly benefits MU by making Chinese memory competitors like CXMT less competitive on US soil. Watch for the export control update expected from Commerce in late August — any tightening on selling advanced HBM to China would hurt near-term revenue (China is ~11% of sales) but reinforce MU's strategic moat. Bottom line: this is a stock where Washington is actively picking winners, and MU is on the winning list.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$922.95
12M Price Target	\$1100.00
Upside / (Downside)	+19.2%
Market Cap	N/A
FY2026E Revenue	\$45,000M
FY2027E Revenue	\$58,000M
FY2026E EPS	\$14.20
FY2027E EPS	\$22.50
Fwd P/E	65.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$1050.00	\$960.00	\$850.00
6 Months	\$1250.00	\$1080.00	\$800.00
1 Year	\$1400.00	\$1100.00	\$750.00
2 Years	\$1700.00	\$1300.00	\$650.00
5 Years	\$2400.00	\$1600.00	\$500.00
10 Years	\$3500.00	\$2000.00	\$400.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+1.77% today) led by semis and AI infrastructure — the "picks and shovels" narrative (memory, networking, power) is broadening beyond just Nvidia. Energy also strong on the 5-day (+6%), reflecting AI datacenter power demand.

COOLING OFF: Financials and Real Estate are lagging — rate cut expectations have been pushed out, and Real Estate is down 2.2% on the week.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating within tech from mega-cap AI names into the supply chain — memory, advanced packaging, and power infrastructure. That's a direct tailwind for MU as the "second derivative" AI play.

RELATED PLAY: If you want less concentrated exposure, look at the advanced packaging names (Amkor, ASE) and datacenter power (Vertiv, Eaton) — they benefit from the same trend without the memory pricing risk.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- 000660.KS (SK Hynix): Leading the memory rally globally — first to qualify HBM3E with Nvidia, capturing premium pricing. Barron's flagged them outpacing MU today.
- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the demand driver — every dollar of Nvidia GPU revenue pulls memory demand behind it.
- AVGO (Broadcom): Custom AI silicon growth is diversifying who buys HBM.

MU CONTEXT: MU is lagging SK Hynix on a relative basis, which actually creates the setup — if you believe memory cycle continues, MU is the catch-up trade with the added US policy tailwind Hynix doesn't have.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — I'm bullish but not table-pounding at these levels; I'd be more excited on a pullback.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — real upside but real volatility, don't oversize.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on pullbacks to \$850-880 (recent consolidation floor) — chasing today's low-volume rip is a bad risk/reward.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months, catalyst is the Q1 FY27 earnings print showing HBM4 traction and margin expansion.

WHEN TO BAIL: If hyperscaler capex guidance disappoints in Q3 earnings, or if MU loses HBM4 socket at Nvidia to Samsung — either one invalidates the thesis.

HEDGING: Buy some protective puts 10-15% below current price for the next 3 months — cheap insurance given how much this stock can move on a bad memory print. Or pair it with a short in a richer-valued AI name to reduce beta exposure.

Tesla, Inc.
TSLA NASDAQ

Hold	\$327.66 ▼ 1.55%	12M Price Target \$340.00	52-Week Range \$297.38 – \$498.83	Market Cap \$1.29T
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TSLA: China Share Slipping, Musk Pay Package Looms Large

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is down 1.55% on very light volume (5M vs usual 25-30M) — that low volume tells me this isn't panic selling, it's a quiet drift lower after a 4-day win streak. The catalyst: Geely officially overtook the Model Y as China's top-selling EV, which is a real dent in the growth story since China is Tesla's #2 market.
- The other headline moving sentiment: chatter about a potential \$824B Musk pay package being revived. Bulls love it (keeps Musk locked in), bears hate the dilution — and the unusual put buying at \$340 strike (~11,000 contracts) suggests some big players are hedging near-term downside.

WHY IT MATTERS

Losing the #1 spot in China to Geely is more than a headline — it signals Tesla's aging lineup (Model Y refresh notwithstanding) is getting outpaced by cheaper, tech-forward Chinese rivals, and this trend probably accelerates before it reverses. The stock sitting at just 15% of its 52-week range tells you the market has already digested a lot of bad news, but it's also not pricing in a real recovery catalyst yet. Watch the Musk pay package vote closely — if it passes, expect a short-term pop on "Elon is staying" relief, but the dilution math (roughly 12% of shares outstanding) is a longer-term overhang nobody's fully modeling. The bullish options flow (P/C ratio 0.99 with call buying at \$245) suggests traders are positioning for a binary outcome, not steady grind.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big policy story hanging over Tesla: the \$7,500 federal EV tax credit expired under the Trump administration's rollback of Biden-era IRA provisions, which structurally raises the effective price of every Tesla sold in the US — this is a headwind that hasn't fully played out in the numbers yet. On the flip side, the administration's push for federal robotaxi/AV regulatory framework (versus a state-by-state patchwork) would be a massive tailwind for Tesla's FSD and Cybercab rollout — watch for NHTSA guidance updates this fall. Tariffs on Chinese battery components are also a double-edged sword: they hurt Tesla's cost structure but hurt Chinese competitors selling in the US more.

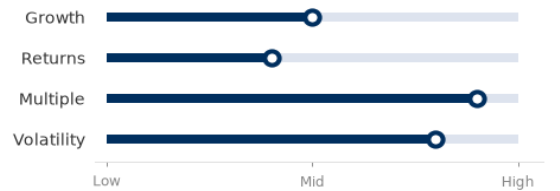
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$328, you're paying roughly 150x forward earnings — meaning investors are shelling out \$150 for every \$1 of profit Tesla is expected to make next year. For context, Toyota trades at ~10x and even Nvidia trades at ~35x. The only way this math works is if you believe robotaxi and Optimus (humanoid robots) turn Tesla into an AI/robotics company, not a car company — that's the entire bull thesis, and it's a leap of faith right now.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$327.66
12M Price Target	\$340.00
Upside / (Downside)	+3.8%
Market Cap	\$1.29T
FY2026E Revenue	\$108M
FY2027E Revenue	\$128M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.15
FY2027E EPS	\$3.10
Fwd P/E	152.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$355.00	\$330.00	\$305.00
6 Months	\$420.00	\$340.00	\$270.00
1 Year	\$500.00	\$340.00	\$240.00
2 Years	\$650.00	\$380.00	\$200.00
5 Years	\$900.00	\$450.00	\$180.00
10 Years	\$1500.00	\$600.00	\$150.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+1.87% 5D) and Energy (+6.05% 5D) — tech is riding the AI capex wave, energy is benefiting from geopolitical premium and administration-friendly drilling policy

COOLING OFF: Real Estate (-2.19% 5D) — rate cut expectations getting pushed out is squeezing REITs

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating into energy and mega-cap tech, but Tesla is stuck in no-man's-land — it's not seen as pure tech (auto exposure) and not seen as pure AI (execution risk on robotaxi). That's why it's underperforming the tech ETF today.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the robotaxi thesis, the picks-and-shovels play is NVDA (chips powering FSD) and lidar/sensor companies. If you're bearish Tesla specifically, BYD (OTC: BYDDY) is the direct beneficiary of Chinese share gains.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Riding sustained AI infrastructure spending — every hyperscaler capex announcement is a tailwind
- GEELY/BYD (Chinese EV makers): Directly taking Tesla's China share with cheaper, better-equipped vehicles

TSLA CONTEXT: Tesla is LAGGING the tech sector today (-1.55% vs XLK +1.77%) — that's a meaningful tell. When your stock can't rally on a green tech day, the market is telling you something specific to the name isn't working. Watch if this divergence persists — that's a signal to trim, not add.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

5/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 5/10 — Cautiously neutral. The optionality is real but the valuation gives you no margin for error, and the China data is genuinely concerning.

POSITION SIZE: 2-3% max — this is a high-volatility name where you want exposure to the robotaxi upside but can't afford to be overweight if the story breaks

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for pullbacks to \$300-310 (near the 52-week low support). Chasing at \$328 with fading momentum and China headwinds isn't the smart trade

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — you need to see robotaxi actually scale to multiple cities and generate real revenue for the thesis to work

WHEN TO BAIL: If Q3 deliveries drop more than 10% YoY, or if robotaxi expansion stalls at Austin only through year-end, cut the position

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — buy some put options (contracts that pay off if the stock falls) at the \$300 strike expiring 3 months out. Costs a small premium but protects you if the China story gets uglier fast

NVIDIA Corporation

NVDA NASDAQ

Buy	\$223.48 ▲ 2.75%	12M Price Target \$265.00	52-Week Range \$164.07 – \$236.54	Market Cap \$5.41T
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NVDA: Chips Rally as AI Spending Wave Keeps Building

WHAT HAPPENED

- NVDA bounced +2.75% today after two red days — the whole chip complex is ripping (Tech ETF +1.77%), so this is sector-wide risk-on, not company-specific news. The narrative catching fire: analysts calling NVDA the "central bank of AI" — meaning they set the price/supply of the most critical commodity in tech right now.
- CoreWeave (CRWV) earnings this week are the real tell — CoreWeave is basically an NVDA reseller (they rent out NVDA chips as cloud compute). If their numbers are strong, it confirms AI demand is still accelerating, which flows straight back to NVDA orders.

WHY IT MATTERS

The options market is screaming bullish — a put/call ratio of 0.47 means traders are buying more than 2 calls (bets stock goes up) for every put (bets it goes down), and we're seeing unusual call buying at \$187-192 strikes that's 2-11x normal volume. That's smart money positioning for a continued melt-up, likely into the next earnings print. The bigger picture: NVDA is trading at 82% of its 52-week range, which sounds topky, but every time the stock consolidates in the \$215-225 zone lately, it breaks higher — that's textbook bullish base-building. The real story is that AI capex from Microsoft, Google, Meta, Amazon is still going UP into 2027, and there's no credible alternative to NVDA's chips at scale yet.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

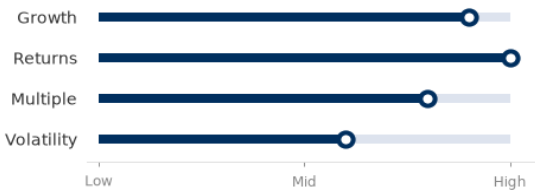
The critical policy angle right now is the Trump administration's China chip deal — NVDA agreed to give the US government 15% of revenue from H2O chip sales to China in exchange for export licenses. This is unusual (basically a revenue-sharing agreement with Uncle Sam) but it re-opens the China market that was effectively closed, which is a net positive despite the tax. Watch for congressional pushback on this arrangement — some hawks in both parties want tighter China restrictions, and if that momentum builds, the H2O pipeline could get squeezed again. Also on the radar: the CHIPS Act 2.0 discussions and any executive orders on federal AI procurement — both directional tailwinds if they advance.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$223.48
12M Price Target	\$265.00
Upside / (Downside)	+18.6%
Market Cap	\$5.41T
FY2026E Revenue	\$205M
FY2027E Revenue	\$265M
FY2026E EPS	\$4.85
FY2027E EPS	\$6.40
Fwd P/E	46.1x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$240.00	\$228.00	\$210.00
6 Months	\$270.00	\$245.00	\$195.00
1 Year	\$310.00	\$265.00	\$180.00
2 Years	\$380.00	\$300.00	\$160.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$400.00	\$180.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$600.00	\$200.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+1.77%) leading everything — chip stocks specifically catching a bid as AI capex numbers keep beating. Energy still hot on the 5-day (+6.05%) because AI data centers need massive power — that's a direct second-order play on NVDA demand.

COOLING OFF: Financials (-0.43% 5D) and Real Estate (-2.19% 5D) — rate cut expectations getting pushed back means less relief for these rate-sensitive sectors.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating INTO AI infrastructure and OUT of defensives — this is a classic risk-on move that tends to favor NVDA specifically because it's the highest-quality liquid AI proxy.

RELATED PLAY: If NVDA keeps running, the power/utility names supplying data centers (VST, CEG) and the networking plays (AVGO, ANET) are the second-order winners — Broadcom especially, which the news flow already highlighted this morning.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): Custom AI chip demand from hyperscalers surging — they're the #2 pick behind NVDA and picking up meaningful share
- CRWV (CoreWeave): Wall Street raising price targets ahead of earnings — pure-play NVDA cloud reseller, its strength = NVDA strength

NVDA CONTEXT: NVDA is leading, not lagging — it's back near 52-week highs while the sector consolidates, which tells you institutional money is still crowding into the highest-quality name. When the leader breaks out first, it usually pulls the group higher — bullish setup.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 5-8% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$210-218 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Hyperscaler capex guidance cuts, China export ban reinstated, or gross margins fall below 65%

Hedging: Buy protective puts 10% out-of-the-money, or pair with SOXS for tail risk

Alphabet Inc.
GOOGL NASDAQ

Buy	\$343.55 ▼ 0.07%	12M Price Target \$380.00	52-Week Range \$196.60 – \$408.61	Market Cap \$4.20T
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GOOGL: Antitrust Overhang Meets AI Momentum — Still A Buy

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is basically flat today (\$343.55, -0.07%) but yesterday's 3.8% drop from \$357 to \$343 is what actually matters — that's the market digesting something. Volume today is a tiny 4M shares (vs. 29M yesterday), meaning most of the action already happened and this is just settling. The 24/7 Wall St. piece framing Meta as "more dangerous than Alphabet" on AI dilution is actually a subtle positive for GOOGL — the narrative is shifting toward Alphabet being the more disciplined AI spender.
- Sergey Brin's "OTHER" transactions at \$0 aren't real sells — those are almost certainly gifts or trust transfers (charitable giving, estate planning). Ignore the "bearish" insider signal here; it's a data artifact.

WHY IT MATTERS

Yesterday's drop looks like profit-taking after a monster run (stock is at 69% of its 52-week range with a \$4.2T market cap — investors who bought at \$250 are sitting on huge gains and locking some in). The bigger story: GOOGL is now trading as an "AI winner" rather than a "Search stock under siege," and that re-rating still has room to run if Gemini keeps taking share. Options flow is telling — the put/call ratio at 0.91 with unusual CALL buying at \$290 and \$300 strikes suggests smart money sees this \$340s zone as a floor, not a ceiling. Watch for the stock to consolidate here before the next leg — the setup is constructive as long as it holds above \$335.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

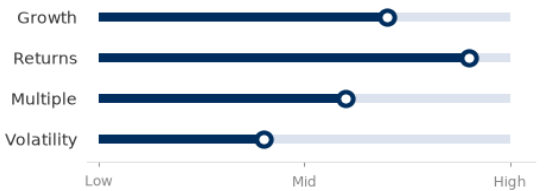
The elephant in the room is still the DOJ antitrust remedy phase — the government is pushing for structural remedies (potentially forcing Google to sell Chrome or unwind default search deals with Apple). If the final remedy is behavioral (rules about conduct) rather than structural (breakup), the stock likely gaps up 5-10% on relief. Separately, the Trump administration's executive orders on federal AI procurement have been broadly favorable to US hyperscalers — GOOGL Cloud is a direct beneficiary of the "American AI stack" push, and any expansion of federal AI spending flows to Google, Microsoft, and Amazon first. EU Digital Markets Act fines remain a nagging cost but are now priced in as a "tax" rather than an existential threat.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

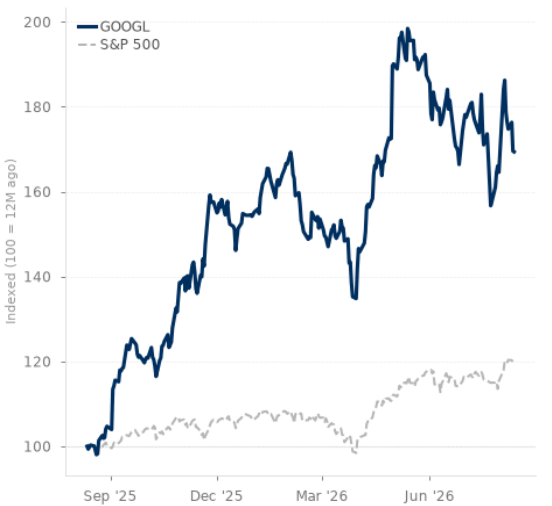
Key Data

Price (USD)	\$343.55
12M Price Target	\$380.00
Upside / (Downside)	+10.6%
Market Cap	\$4.20T
FY2026E Revenue	\$408M
FY2027E Revenue	\$462M
FY2026E EPS	\$9.85
FY2027E EPS	\$11.40
Fwd P/E	34.9x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$365.00	\$350.00	\$325.00
6 Months	\$400.00	\$370.00	\$300.00
1 Year	\$430.00	\$380.00	\$290.00
2 Years	\$500.00	\$425.00	\$280.00
5 Years	\$700.00	\$550.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$1100.00	\$800.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech (+1.77% today, +1.87% over 5 days) is the clear leader — AI capex is still the dominant market theme, and every earnings print from CoreWeave, Broadcom, and the hyperscalers reinforces it. Energy is also running (+6% over 5 days) on AI power demand narrative.

COOLING OFF: Financials (-0.43% 5D) and Real Estate (-2.19% 5D) are lagging — rate cut expectations have been pushed out, which hurts rate-sensitive sectors.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing from defensive/rate-sensitive names into AI infrastructure and the picks-and-shovels plays (Broadcom, CoreWeave) — that's a tailwind for GOOGL's cloud business, which sells the shovels.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the GOOGL thesis, the second-order winners are data center power (Vistra, Constellation) and networking chips (Broadcom, Arista) — they benefit whether GOOGL, MSFT, or META wins the AI race.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): Winning on the "if AI wins, we win" thesis — they supply custom chips (including Google's TPUs) so they benefit from GOOGL's capex directly.
- MSFT (Microsoft): 54 analysts, all bullish per today's headlines — Copilot monetization and Azure AI growth keep beating expectations.

GOOGL CONTEXT: GOOGL is roughly in line with mega-cap AI peers but has lagged MSFT and META slightly over the past month due to antitrust overhang. That's actually the setup for a catch-up trade — same AI exposure, cheaper multiple, and a specific catalyst (DOJ resolution) that could close the gap.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 5-7% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$335-345 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: DOJ forces Chrome/Android divestiture OR cloud growth decelerates below 20%

Hedging: Small put spread on QQQ for broad AI/mega-cap exposure

Marvell Technology, Inc.

MRVL NASDAQ

Buy	\$223.00 ▲ 5.04%	12M Price Target \$265.00	52-Week Range \$61.44 – \$329.88	Market Cap \$200.15B
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MRVL: AI Custom Silicon Play Riding CHIPS Act Tailwinds

WHAT HAPPENED

- MRVL popped 5% on light volume (only 5.5M shares vs the usual 18M+) — that's a squeeze move, not a conviction move. The real driver: CoreWeave and Super Micro crushed earnings overnight, which is basically the market saying "AI infrastructure spending is still going full throttle." MRVL sells the custom chips and networking gear that powers exactly that buildout, so it got dragged up in sympathy.
- The \$250M India investment announcement is a quiet but meaningful signal — Marvell is diversifying its engineering base away from China exposure, which matters given the political backdrop (more on that below).

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what the tape is telling me: MRVL is trading like a high-beta proxy for the AI capex cycle. When CoreWeave (an AI cloud provider) beats numbers, MRVL rips — that's the market pricing in more custom silicon orders from hyperscalers like Amazon and Microsoft. But the low volume on today's move is a yellow flag; it means the rally is being driven by short covering and momentum chasers, not institutions accumulating. The bigger picture: options market is pricing in a HUGE move on earnings (the Trefis headline says the stock could halve or double), which tells you nobody knows if the custom AI silicon story is real growth or a one-hyperscaler concentration risk waiting to blow up.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

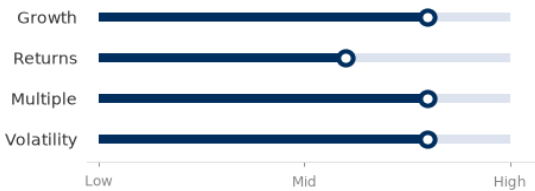
The CHIPS Act (the 2022 law that hands out federal money to semiconductor companies building in the US) is the biggest tailwind here — Marvell doesn't manufacture chips itself, but its customers (TSMC's US fabs, hyperscaler data centers) all benefit from the subsidies, which flows back to MRVL as design wins. Watch the export control front closely: the Commerce Department has been steadily tightening rules on advanced chip exports to China, and MRVL gets roughly 40% of revenue from China — any new restrictions on networking or storage chips would hit them directly. Also on the radar: the AI Diffusion Rule framework (Biden-era, now being modified under Trump) — if the administration loosens rules for allied countries but tightens for China, MRVL's India expansion positions them perfectly for that split.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$223.00
12M Price Target	\$265.00
Upside / (Downside)	+18.8%
Market Cap	\$200.15B
FY2027E Revenue	\$8,400M
FY2028E Revenue	\$10,800M
FY2027E EPS	\$2.85
FY2028E EPS	\$4.10
Fwd P/E	78.2x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



MRVL — Marvell Technology, Inc. | August 12, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$245.00	\$228.00	\$200.00
6 Months	\$285.00	\$250.00	\$180.00
1 Year	\$330.00	\$265.00	\$160.00
2 Years	\$400.00	\$300.00	\$140.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$380.00	\$150.00
10 Years	\$800.00	\$500.00	\$180.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech (+1.77% today) led by AI infrastructure names — CoreWeave/SMCI earnings validated that hyperscaler capex is still accelerating, and every semi with AI exposure is riding that wave. Energy is quietly ripping (+6% over 5 days) as power demand for AI data centers becomes a real thesis.

COOLING OFF: Financials and Real Estate are lagging — rate uncertainty and the yield curve are keeping money out. Real estate down 2%+ on the week suggests rate cut expectations are getting pushed out.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing from defensives (utilities, staples) into AI-adjacent tech AND energy — the "AI needs power" trade is becoming its own thing. That's a double tailwind for MRVL since their chips go into the data centers driving that power demand.

RELATED PLAY: If MRVL keeps running, look at the second derivative — power/cooling names (VRT), optical networking (LITE, COHR), and the fabs themselves (TSM). Lumentum was in this morning's headlines for a reason.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): The \$10T market cap chatter this morning is unhinged but reflects the reality — NVDA is still setting the pace and every AI semi trades on its coattails.
- AVGO (Broadcom): MRVL's closest custom silicon comp. Options market is pricing big moves in both — they move together.
- CRWV (CoreWeave): Blew out earnings, validating the AI cloud demand story that MRVL sells picks-and-shovels into.

MRVL CONTEXT: MRVL is at 60% of its 52-week range (\$61-\$329) — meaning it's recovered nicely from the lows but still well off the highs. That tells me it's lagging the peer group (NVDA and AVGO are closer to highs), which could mean either "catch-up trade coming" or "the market knows something." Given the healthy institutional ownership (94%) and no insider selling, I lean toward catch-up.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-4% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$205-215 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Loss of Amazon Trainium or Google TPU custom silicon socket, or AI capex slowdown

Hedging: Long-dated puts or pair against overheated AI names like SMCI

The following stocks were identified by screening a curated universe against the current watchlist's investment themes, today's macro environment, and smart-money signals. Scores reflect theme alignment, momentum, valuation, and institutional flow. These are research leads — not investment advice.

1	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc. Defense Technology	8.9/10	BUY
Price: \$139.15 · 1M: +30.6% · P/S: 1.0x · Cap: \$17.5B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL				
2	AVAV	AeroVironment, Inc. Defense Technology	8.2/10	BUY
Price: \$192.31 · 1M: +35.6% · P/S: 4.9x · Cap: \$9.7B				
■ Monitor for pullback to \$175 entry				
OPT:NEUT INS:NEUT INST:BULL				
3	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc. Semiconductors	8.9/10	BUY
Price: \$35.87 · 1M: +29.5% · P/S: 0.7x · Cap: \$23.2B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL				
4	MDB	MongoDB, Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.5/10	BUY
Price: \$438.27 · 1M: +29.7% · P/S: 13.5x · Cap: \$35.3B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL				
5	PATH	UiPath, Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.6/10	WATCH
Price: \$15.07 · 1M: +27.2% · P/S: 4.7x · Cap: \$7.8B				
■ Monitor for pullback to \$13 entry				
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL				